JUSTIN THOMAS



Senior Project Manager — Utility-Scale BESS & Solar | IPP · Owner's Engineer · EPC

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior project manager with **11+ continuous years in utility-scale renewables**, delivering **~1 GWh of battery energy storage and ~3.9 GW of solar** across the **full project lifecycle** — design review, vendor qualification and FAT, construction, testing, commissioning and handover to COD. Currently leading delivery of a **125 MW / 500 MWh standalone LFP BESS**, having previously acted as Owner's Engineer on a **500 MW BESS + solar hybrid** — two 500 MWh-class storage programmes run from opposite sides of the contract.

Brings **IPP / developer-side experience** at Tata Power Renewable Energy, managing EPC contractors across ~750 MW of solar on behalf of the asset owner, plus the Owner's Engineer, EPC and government-agency perspectives that let him anticipate where contractors, OEMs and lenders will push back. Track record of working across multi-state sites and OEM factories, with full flexibility to travel.

~1 GWh	~3.9 GW	11+ yrs	4 sides
BESS delivered / overseen	utility-scale solar	renewables, 4 states + island UT	IPP · OE/TPI · EPC · Agency

CORE COMPETENCIES

- ▸ Utility-scale BESS project delivery
- ▸ Full lifecycle: NTP → COD → handover
- ▸ IPP / owner-side EPC management
- ▸ Schedule, milestone & progress control
- ▸ OEM / vendor management, FAT & PDI
- ▸ Contract-aware deviation & claims review
- ▸ LFP containers, PCS, EMS/SCADA
- ▸ HV/MV BoP & 145 kV interconnection
- ▸ Testing, commissioning & punch-list
- ▸ QA/QC: QAP, ITP, NCR, RCA, CAPA
- ▸ Risk, HSE & permit-to-work
- ▸ Stakeholder & multi-agency coordination
- ▸ DPR / MIS executive reporting
- ▸ MS Project, AutoCAD
- ▸ Lean Six Sigma Green Belt

UTILITY-SCALE PROJECT PORTFOLIO

Project	Capacity	Location	Role / Side of Contract
JSW Renew Energy 38L — Standalone LFP BESS	125 MW / 500 MWh	Kasaragod, Kerala	EPC — Manager, Electrical Projects
Khavda BESS + Solar Hybrid	500 MW	Khavda, Gujarat	Owner's Engineer / TPI
Siyambar / Bandha Solar	1,034 MW	Jaisalmer, Rajasthan	Owner's Engineer / TPI
TP Solapur Solar	**450 MWp / 335 MW AC**	**Bikaner, Rajasthan**	**IPP / Developer — Project Lead**
Dholera Solar	**300 MW**	**Dholera, Gujarat**	**IPP / Developer — Project Lead**
Pavagada Solar Park	2,050 MW	Tumakuru, Karnataka	Implementing Agency (SECI)
Lakshadweep Island BESS	1.4 MWh	Lakshadweep, UT	Implementing Agency (SECI)
Cochin International Airport Solar	25.4 MW	Kochi, Kerala	EPC & O&M

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Manager – Electrical Projects BESS

Aug 2025 – Present

Amara Raja Infra Pvt. Ltd. (ARIPL) — EPC Contractor

125 MW / 500 MWh standalone LFP BESS for JSW Renew Energy Thirty-Eight Ltd., Kasaragod, Kerala · Owner's Engineer: Tata Consulting Engineers

- Leads electrical project delivery for one of India's largest standalone storage assets under construction — containerised LFP battery systems, PCS, MV/HV balance of plant and the **145 kV evacuation interface**.
- Owns the multi-OEM interface — Gotion (LFP containers), Hopewind (PCS), Shilchar & Trisquare (transformers, MV panels), CG Power, KEC (cables), Smart Grid (EMS/SCADA), Fuji Electric (UPS) — driving drawing approvals, pre-dispatch inspection, site acceptance and defect closure to protect schedule.
- Stood up the site project-control and quality regime: **278-entry RFI register tracked to closure**, NCR/observation management, RCA and CAPA reporting, post-pour foundation checklists — keeping the project continuously audit-ready for the Owner's Engineer and IPP client.

Owner's Engineer — Quality & Inspection BESS

Aug 2023 – Aug 2025

TQ Cert Services Pvt. Ltd. (Tata Projects Ltd.) — Owner's Engineer / TPI

500 MW BESS + solar hybrid, Khavda, Gujarat | 1,034 MW Siyambar / Bandha solar, Jaisalmer, Rajasthan

- Served as the owner's technical and quality authority on two of the country's largest renewable programmes, protecting owner interests against EPC contractor performance.
- Reviewed and approved contractor QAPs, ITPs and field procedures; enforced hold and witness points so stage clearances were evidence-based rather than schedule-driven.
- Travelled to OEM works for **FAT and pre-dispatch inspection** of battery systems, inverters, transformers, switchgear and modules — stopping non-conforming equipment before it reached site.

- Carried out design and drawing reviews, adjudicated deviation and concession requests on technical merit, and issued, tracked and closed contractor NCRs through formal audits.

Project Lead IPP

Aug 2022 – Aug 2023

Tata Power Renewable Energy Ltd. (TPREL) — IPP / Developer

450 MWp / 335 MW AC solar, Bikaner, Rajasthan | 300 MW solar, Dholera, Gujarat | EV charging operations

- Led **owner-side project execution for one of India's largest IPPs** across ~750 MW of utility-scale solar in two states, holding EPC contractors to schedule, quality and safety commitments.
- Governed progress through site reviews, milestone verification and punch-list closure, driving contractors through commissioning to **commercial-operation readiness**.
- Coordinated engineering, procurement, contracts, HSE and O&M to resolve interface issues and keep multi-package sites in sequence, across sites in Rajasthan and Gujarat.

Project Engineer — Implementation BESS

Oct 2020 – Aug 2022

Solar Energy Corporation of India (SECI) — Central Implementing Agency

2,050 MW Pavagada Solar Park, Karnataka | 1.4 MWh island BESS, Lakshadweep

- Monitored developer and contractor delivery against scheme milestones on the 2,050 MW Pavagada Solar Park, one of the world's largest solar parks.
- Delivered a **1.4 MWh island BESS** under logistically constrained island conditions — early hands-on grounding in storage integration.
- Built the tendering, policy and stakeholder perspective that now informs bid-stage scrutiny and contract-aware decisions.

Electrical Engineer — Execution & O&M

Jun 2015 – Oct 2020

KC Kopar Energy Solutions

25.4 MW solar at Cochin International Airport Ltd. (CIAL) — the world's first fully solar-powered airport

- Five-year tenure executing and operating 25.4 MW across ground-mount, rooftop and canopy installations inside a live, security-controlled airport.
- Managed installation, testing and commissioning of modules, inverters, LT/HT switchgear, transformers and evacuation, then ran plant O&M — building the failure-mode knowledge behind current delivery judgement.

TECHNICAL EXPOSURE

BESS: containerised LFP systems, PCS, BMS/EMS, SCADA integration, HVAC and fire detection/suppression interfaces, DC cabling and combiner architecture.

Solar: crystalline PV, string and central inverters, fixed-tilt and tracker structures, IDTs, pooling substations, evacuation.

HV / MV: power and auxiliary transformers, 145 kV SF_6 breakers, CTs/PTs, 33 kV HT panels, AC/DC boards, UPS, protection and earthing.

Standards & tools: ISO 9001:2015, IEC / IEEE, MS Project, AutoCAD.

EDUCATION, CERTIFICATION & AVAILABILITY

B.Tech, Electrical & Electronics Engineering — SCMS School of Engineering & Technology, Cochin (2011 – 2015) · **Lean Six Sigma Green Belt (CLSSGB)**

Languages: English, Malayalam, Hindi, Tamil · **Availability:** Immediate · **Travel:** fully flexible